

section 3.2: If-Else

The syntax description here may seem to suggest that *statement*₁ and *statement*₂ must be single, simple statements, but, as mentioned in section 3.1, a block of statements enclosed in braces {} is equivalent to a single statement.

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``Coding shortcuts" like

```
if (expression)
```

can indeed be cryptic, but they're also quite common, so you'll need to be able to recognize them even if you don't choose to write them in your own code. Whenever you see code like

```
if (x)
```

or

```
if (f())
```

where `x` or `f()` do not have obvious ``Boolean" names, just mentally add in `!= 0`.

Don't worry too much if the multiple `if/else` ambiguity described on page 56 doesn't make perfect sense; just note the deep sentence:

...it's a good idea to use braces when there are nested `ifs`.

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